Helping verbs in a paragraph

Name: _____ Date: _____

Read the paragraph. Find the ten verb phrases (a helping verb plus a main verb). Write each pair in the table.

THE CLASS GARDEN

Our class has planted a vegetable garden behind the gym. Every morning two students are watering the beds, and Mr Ortiz is checking for slugs. The beans have grown taller than the fence already. Last week we were pulling weeds when a rabbit hopped out of the lettuce. It had eaten three whole plants! Now we must build a small fence, and the caretaker will help us on Friday. If the weather stays warm, the tomatoes should ripen before the holidays. We can hardly wait to make a salad from our own garden.

VERB PHRASES

#	Helping verb	Main verb

#	Helping verb	Main verb

THINK ABOUT IT

1. Which verb phrase tells about something that happened before the rabbit hopped out?

2. Which two verb phrases tell about the future?

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Helping verbs in a paragraph - Answer key

VERB PHRASES

1. has planted
2. are watering
3. is checking
4. have grown
5. were pulling
6. had eaten
7. must build
8. will help
9. should ripen
10. can wait

THINK ABOUT IT

1. had eaten
2. will help; should ripen (accept must build)

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